



Uber launches new app for drivers

The move follows the '180-days of change' programme to incorporate changes requested by the drivers. <https://digit.in/ubrapp>



Oreo on 4.6% Android Devices

While a miniscule 4.6% Android devices sport Oreo, Lollipop still hosts 38.6% of the Android devices population. <https://digit.in/anoreo>

W

hether you are moving into a brand new home (congratulations to you), ditching your old furniture, you're most likely to look up furniture and other home furnishing items online. Imagine, on a furnishing app, you chose a new armchair for your living room, pick a colour, a material and then tap a button to see it right there in your room in augmented reality. You outsource your entire home's interior design to one such startup and a couple of weeks later, you get a VR walkthrough of your brand new home - before one piece of wood has been cut or one can of paint has been opened. Here's how all of that has already become a reality.

OH SO UNORGANISED!

Home decor and design market has been largely unorganised so far. Just look around at everything that goes into your home - the upholstery, woodwork, paint, metalwork, electrical wiring - and it is quite clear why it has traditionally taken ages to get an entire house furnished/reworked. The best, and most expensive approach would be to hand over the entire project to an interior designer. They'd be running from vendor to vendor to get the best prices possible. Costs would escalate and so would the completion time, and you'd have little to no clarity save for a few sketches on paper or unflattering CAD layouts.

Perhaps the biggest feat that home furnishing startups have achieved, is to bring all of this together under one um-



For a long time, this was the only way you could visualise your home's interior design plan before it got executed.

brella. Home design startups like Livspace and Furdo have brought the entire lifecycle of home design, right from the initial consultations with the designer to the post-completion maintenance and alterations under one single platform. Even comparatively focussed platforms like Urban Ladder are now offering design services through things like the Urban Ladder Design Network. It is certainly working.

BRINGING IT TOGETHER

One of the big names among interior furnishing startups right now is Livs-

WHAT DESIGNERS GET

Back in 2015, Livspace acquired DesignUp, a design community and marketplace and Dwll.in, an online network of designers. With this, they had easy access to a ready community of designers at their disposal. From that point, they've received more than 15000 applications out of which around 2000 designers are now part of the platform. Furdo has a different approach when it comes to onboarding designers. For them, designers must intern under a 'design-ist' on their platform or go through a Furdo certi-

TO BUILD A HOME

Furnishing and interior design startups are harnessing technology to build you a perfect home.

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pace, and it has the numbers to back its reputation up. With 5000+ customers, 2 million + sq. foot designed and a typical project frequency of 300/ month. But there's more to these numbers than just milestones.

Livspace, much like other startups in this area, started off with the goal of being a technology platform. In their own words, "Livspace is a three-way platform, bringing together homeowners, designers and vendors." Right now, nothing speaks of their goal better than Canvas, a cloud-based home-design-automation platform.

fication programme. In both cases, the designers benefit from the exercise.

A primary reason behind that is the platform they work on. The same platform onboards customers at the front-end, lets them browse through catalogs, interact with their designers and receive estimates, documents. On the designer side, the platform lets them create everything from simple and complex documentation, mood boards, to even full-scale 3D layouts of the house - where all the SKUs in the design are itemised and a quote is generated in real time.